

A holistic health care

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A holistic health care

Introduction:

Holistic health is an approach to wellness that simultaneously addresses the physical, mental, emotional, social, and spiritual components of health. As a field of practice, holistic medicine draws from many disciplines, religions, and cultures to heal people, communities, and even the environment.

Areas of holistic health (Areas that holistic health may examine):

When people begin to look beyond just the body and to the wider spectrum of wellness, five areas of health come into focus.

- Physical Health
- Emotional Health
- Social Health
- Spiritual Health
- Intellectual Health



Physical Health (Body): When body is healthy; functioning at the optimal level

- What are the body's needs for nutrition, sleep, exercise, and rejuvenation?
- What are the underlying causes of physical pain?
- What steps can be taken to ameliorate this pain or live with it?
- What actions can be taken to prevent bodily injury, illness, and disease?

Emotional Health (Mind): Is the ability to cope with life events, as well as both positive and negative emotions.

- What are the mind's needs for stimulation, curiosity, wonder, and creative expression?
- What information and lessons do emotions provide?
- What is an embodied account of the mind and spirit?
- What are its interdependent connections with others and the environment?

Spiritual Health (Spirit): Those who have strong religious connections may find this in strengthening their bond and understanding of God

- What practices and rituals connect us with something larger than ourselves?
- How can we connect with the divine, with nature, with ancestors, and with other sources of deep purpose and meaning beyond oneself

Social Health (relationship): connections and to be surrounded by people

- How is one connected to others?
- What ways can tie with kin, friends, loved ones, neighbors, and strangers be strengthened, renewed, and repaired?
- How can one give time and resources generously, draw healthy boundaries, and cultivate community?

Social Health (culture): connections and to be surrounded by people

- What is one's cultural inheritance?
- What values and traditions, including art, performances, ceremonies, rites, crafts, and ways of life; would one like to bring into the present and preserve for the future?
- What can one's culture teach us about living healthily and well?

Environment:

- What are the unique features of the space one lives in, the neighborhood, geography, flora, and fauna?
- Who lives nearby, and how has this place changed over time?
- What is the history of this place?
- How does this place affect one's health, is it clean, welcoming, loud, harsh, disruptive, joyful, or peaceful?
- What healing and help does this environment need to be healthy?

Health Care Models

Conventional Health Care Model

Focus: Conventional medicine (also known as allopathic medicine) is centered on diagnosing and treating specific diseases or symptoms using medical interventions such as medications, surgery, and diagnostic tests.

Approach: This model tends to focus on the physical body and may treat symptoms individually without always addressing the underlying causes, such as lifestyle factors or emotional well-being.

Health Care Models:

Strengths: It is highly effective for acute conditions and life-threatening illnesses and uses evidence-based practices to treat diseases.

Limitations: Conventional medicine often lacks a comprehensive approach to prevention, mental health, and chronic disease management

Health Care Models:

Holistic Health Care Model

Focus: Holistic health care looks at the entire individual mind, body, and spirit and aims to promote overall wellness. It focuses on prevention, lifestyle changes, and the body's natural ability to heal itself.

Approach: It integrates a variety of treatment modalities, including conventional medicine, alternative therapies, stress management techniques, and lifestyle changes.

Health Care Models:

Strengths: Holistic health addresses the root causes of illness, promotes prevention, and considers the mental and emotional aspects of health.

Limitations: Some alternative therapies used in holistic health care may lack the scientific evidence and standardized protocols that conventional medicine relies on.

Roles and Responsibilities of a Holistic Nurse:

- A holistic nurse has a responsibility to apply the principles of holistic care to patients within their practice.
- A holistic nurse may administer the same health care services as a traditional registered nurse, but they differ in their method of delivery.

Holistic nurses deliver care in the following ways:

- ***Compassionate:*** Holistic nurses are attentive, present and compassionate toward patients.
- ***Comprehensive:*** Holistic nurses acknowledge the mind, body and spirit by treating the entire person rather than treating one symptom.
- ***Curious:*** Holistic nurses believe that a variety of factors affect health, from environmental influences to dietary choices. As a result, they ask their patients questions about their overall lifestyle.



Holistic Caring Process

Holistic nursing practice is guided by the holistic caring process, whether used with individuals, families, population groups, or communities. Holistic caring process is the process of the nurse and client coming together in a mutual and professional interaction/relationship. It based on the following:

An assessment process: including appropriate traditional and holistic methods to systematically gather information.

Patterns/Challenges/Needs: Holistic nurses identify and prioritize each person's actual and potential patterns/challenges/needs and life processes related to health, wellness, disease, or illness, which may or may not facilitate wellbeing.

Planning/Outcomes Identification: Holistic nurses specify appropriate outcomes for each person's actual or potential patterns/challenges/needs.

Therapeutic Care Plan: Holistic nurses engage each person to mutually create an appropriate plan of care that focuses on health promotion, recovery, restoration, or peaceful dying so that the person is as independent as possible.

Implementation: Holistic nurses prioritize each person's plan of holistic care, and holistic nursing interventions are implemented accordingly.

Evaluation: Holistic nurses evaluate each person's response to holistic care regularly and systematically and the continuing holistic nature of the healing process is recognized and honored.

Using NOPQRST format:

(N) Normal: Describe normal baseline. That means what was it like before this symptom developed?

(O) Onset: When did the symptom start? What day? What time? Did it start suddenly or gradually?

(P) Precipitating and palliative factors: What brought on the symptom? What seems to trigger it—factors such as stress, position change, or exertion? What were you doing when you first noticed the symptom? What makes the symptom worse? What measures have helped relieve the symptom? What have you tried so far? What measures did not relieve the symptom?

(Q) Quality and quantity: How does it feel? How would you describe it? How much are you experiencing now? Is it more or less than you experienced at any other time?

(R) Region and radiation: Where does the symptom occur? Can you show me? In the case of pain, does it travel anywhere such as down your arm or in your back?

(S) Severity: On a scale of 0 to 10, with 0 being the absence of pain and 10 being the worst ever experienced, rate your symptom. How bad is the symptom at its worst? Does it force you to stop your activity and sit down, lie down, or slow down? Is the symptom getting better or worse, or staying about the same?

(T) Time: How long does the symptom last? How often do you get the symptom? Does it occur in association with anything, such as before, during, or after meals?

Key Systems in Holistic Health:

- **The Immune System:** is central to maintaining health. It defends the body against infections, toxins, and abnormal cell growth.
- **Circulatory System:** The heart, blood vessels, and blood work together to supply oxygen and nutrients to tissues and remove waste products.
- **Respiratory System:** The lungs and airways facilitate gas exchange—vital for oxygenating the blood and removing carbon dioxide.

- **Digestive System:** The gut breaks down food and absorbs nutrients. It also plays a major role in immune function and mental health (the gut-brain connection).
- **Nervous System:** The brain, spinal cord, and nerves coordinate body functions and enable communication between systems. It is directly influenced by emotional and mental states.
- **Endocrine System:** Glands such as the thyroid, adrenal glands, and pancreas release hormones that regulate metabolism, growth, and mood.

- The holistic view emphasizes the need to maintain balance and harmony among all these systems to maintain health. For instance, emotional stress (a mental or emotional state) can affect the nervous system, which in turn may impact the digestive system or cardiovascular system.

A top-down view of a desk with various items. In the center is a spiral-bound notebook with a white cover. On the notebook, a pair of black-rimmed glasses is placed. To the left of the notebook is a small potted succulent with green, fleshy leaves. To the right are two yellow sticky notes, one of which has a red pencil resting on it. Below the notebook is a black pen. To the left of the notebook is a small yellow flower and a black object. The background is a light-colored, textured surface.

**ANY
QUESTIONS?**

Short Quiz

How does holistic health care differ from conventional health care?

- a. It focuses exclusively on curing diseases
- b. It ignores evidence-based practices
- c. It emphasizes whole-person care rather than just treating symptoms
- d. It is incompatible with modern medicine

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Describe the meaning strains of (N) and (O) of the NOPQRST format:

(N)

(O)

Using NOPQRST format:

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A rectangular, light brown cardboard tag with a hole on the left side, through which a dark, fibrous string is threaded. The tag is placed on a rough, light-colored wooden surface. Several bright green, serrated leaves are scattered around the tag, some in the foreground and some in the background, creating a natural, rustic feel. The text 'Thank you!' is written in a black, cursive script on the tag. A faint 'dreamstime' watermark is visible across the middle of the image.

Thank
you!